Broadening Educational Outcomes: Social Learning, Skills Development and Employability for Youth

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Introduction

- Skills and academic learning dominate the post-2015 development agenda
- Yet, we need to account for the multidimensional inequalities that some youth face in education
- We argue that social learning is an important learning outcome for schools to foster

The sites and youth

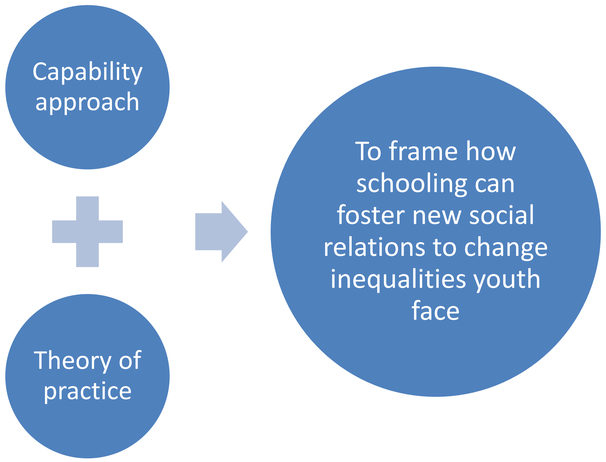
- Two boarding secondary schools (Sasema and Usawa) implementing entrepreneurship education in semi-rural areas of Tanzania
- Both sites target youth living in extreme poverty



Research question

What, in addition to knowledge and skills, do youth from marginalized backgrounds need to participate in the labor market and improve their future well-being?

Conceptual framework



Study design

- Longitudinal mixed-methods design
- Qualitative data from multiple sources:
  - 55 in-depth interviews with youth each year for two years
  - 50 in-depth interviews with NGO and key stakeholders over two years

Youths' economic and social constraints

- Youth from these communities are generally perceived as trouble-makers and risky for community 'investment'
- Girls have additional challenges:
  - *"There is no confidence in the young girls. That is why, at Sasema School, we are trying to impart being confident"*
- Nepotism was stressed as *"killing the country"*

RESULTS

Affiliation – engaging in social interactions and treating others with equal worth

- *The college [has] give[n] me aspiration to achieve my goals…I have learned in life skills how youth can deal with challenges in life so this has given me light…The other change is the sense of value by people. Last time I was not valued by my father when I give opinion but now when I come to school, when I give my opinion, my father can listen to me and also the community,"*

Care – mutual relation between teachers and students or students and students

- *"All the teachers are wonderful and love us…I am proud of my school because there is love, it has people with love. There is closeness between students and students and teachers and students."*



Imagining alternative futures – imagination is an important capability fostered by education

- *"When I will move from here I will have the skills of becoming a carpenter. I'll be able to make anything. I've never seen a woman who is a carpenter."*
- *"My life will be different because I will be an educated girl, I'll know how to plan my things and how to decide for myself, unlike girls who have never been to school. There's a difference."*